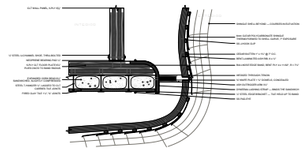
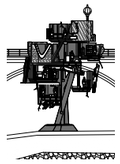
SEVEN SHEETS, LEFT TO RIGHT



P01 DETAIL DRAWING

1" = 1'-0"

The floor edge is hung, not propped: a steel T-hanger and a Dyneema strap carry the earth-tile sandwich, and every part stays within the crew's reach to retension.



P02 SLIVER DRAWING

NOT TO SCALE

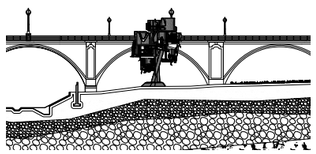
One sliver holds the whole loop: sediment is hoisted in, worked into soil, and grown into plants, with the crew visible on every floor.



P03 SLIVER RENDER

PERSPECTIVE

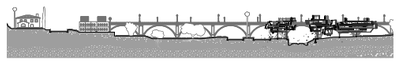
From the river path, the sliver rises beside the bridge on a single red mast, and the veil turns the work on each floor into silhouette.



P04 BUILDING SECTION

1/16" = 1'-0"

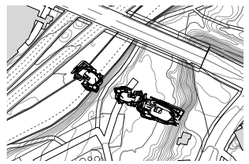
Set against the bridge's arches, one sliver stands on the bank on a single footing, leaving the channel and the riverbed clear.



P05 OVERALL SECTION

1/32" = 1'-0"

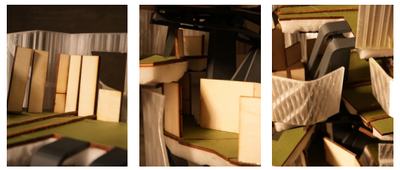
The three masses hang over the channel beneath the bridge, putting the river's upkeep in view of the road, the path, and the bridge.



P06 FLOOR PLAN

1/32" = 1'-0"

The masses sit on the banks and reach over the channel, so the river stays open and the work faces the public path.



P07 MODEL PHOTOGRAPHS

THREE VIEWS

Ply walls, layered floor plates, and a clear printed veil: the model tests how the work reads as silhouette through the skin.

Arroyo Seco Sediment Node

ARROYO SECO STABLES, SOUTH PASADENA

34° 06′ 43.8″ N 118° 10′ 37.1″ W



THE CHANNEL



DEBRIS AT THE SITE

Brandon Avalos

Hume Vertical Studio
SCI-Arc FA26
Midterm Review, October 19, 2026

“After the revolution, who’s going to pick up the garbage on Monday morning?”

MIERLE LADERMAN UKELES, MANIFESTO FOR MAINTENANCE ART, 1969

Maintenance that is hidden gets abandoned. A sediment node makes it public, permanent, and productive.

PROBLEM

Fire-loosened sediment from the San Gabriels collects behind Devil’s Gate Dam, where the County digs it out and trucks it away as waste, out of public view.

PROPOSAL

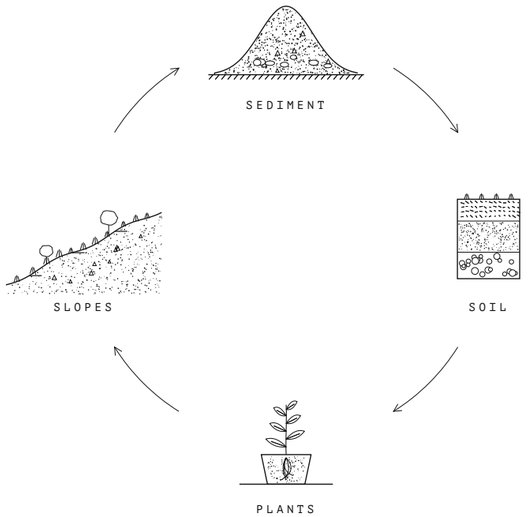
Turn that hidden chore into a public, permanent, paid operation at the Arroyo Seco Stables in South Pasadena.

THE CREW

People in recovery, in reentry, or displaced by fire do the work, and the work rebuilds the land, the river, and the crew.

NEXT CANYON OVER

The January 2025 Eaton Fire ran the whole cycle: burn, debris flow, emergency dig-out, contaminated sediment.



SEDIMENT > SOIL > PLANTS > SLOPES > LESS SEDIMENT

THE BUILDING

Three masses, tied together by an elevated public walk.

MASS 1	FAR EAST	Receiving, testing, sorting, compost, earth workshop, stables
MASS 2	EAST BANK, OVER THE CHANNEL	Nursery, gathering hub, crew housing
MASS 3	WEST SIDE, OVER THE CHANNEL	Treatment wetland, release weir

STRUCTURE

A hybrid of steel and CLT, with masts hanging the floors.

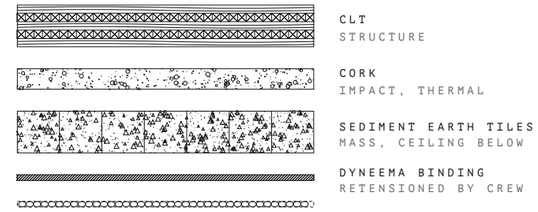
FLOOR PLATE

It sags and is retensioned by the crew, so the building performs the maintenance it argues for.

WALLS

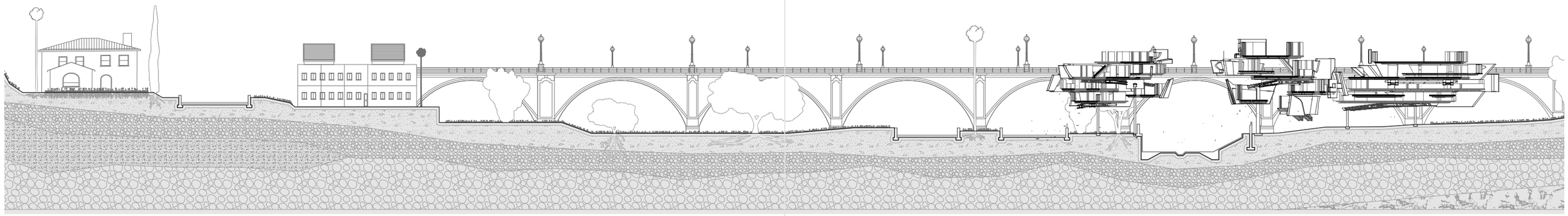
Sandwich panels: two thin skins held apart by a cork core, stiff from depth, not mass.

FLOOR PLATE / TOP TO BOTTOM



SKIN

The veil: bio-polycarbonate shingles of controlled transparency that flutter and open through pneumatic gills. From the river path, the work reads as silhouettes.



OVERALL SECTION / THREE MASSES ACROSS THE CHANNEL

REDUCED / P05 ON THE WALL AT 1/32" = 1'-0"